Module 1 · Workbook answers

What are your values?

Video: 43 min **Answer sheet**

This first module lays the foundation for the whole course: what coaching is, why knowing things is not the same as changing, and how to find your values by connecting them to the attributes of Allah. When your values are clear, they give your life a direction and turn even ordinary moments into purposeful ones.

Answer sheet: the answers are in red. The reflection questions are personal, so your own answers will be in your own words and from your own life. These model answers show what the session teaches, to guide and check your thinking.

Key teachings

1. **Why are you here?**
   People join for different reasons: career problems or wanting to start their own thing, difficulties with a spouse or children, a spiritual connection that feels like something is missing, or simply no clear direction. Many of us did everything society expected (school, university, job, house, marriage, children) and then asked, "What is the point of all of this?" Ask yourself honestly which of these brought you here, so you can come out the other end with a real improvement in that area.

2. **What coaching is: speed and troubleshooting**
   We live in the information age, so the problem is not a lack of information but overwhelm: with so much choice we end up making no choices and not progressing. Coaching does two things. First, speed: someone a little further ahead tells you what to do so you reach your goal in the least time, because our most precious commodity is time, not money. Second, troubleshooting: when problems come up on the way, you have a community to turn to for solutions and suggestions.

3. **Knowing is not enough: it is about change**
   How often have we listened to an inspiring talk, gone home, and nothing changed? Shaytan (Satan) has more knowledge than any of us, so knowledge alone is not the goal. The Companions of the Prophet ﷺ did not always have much knowledge, but they changed their lives, going from people who buried their daughters alive to people who changed the world. It is common to find someone who is a leader in the community but fights with their family at home; the aim is to improve in every area of life.

4. **What values are**
   In the live session people described values as the principles you live your life by, what shapes your personality, and your roadmap in life. Your values can be informed by your religion, whatever your background, but some values matter more to you than others. Being clear on your values, and where they come from, means every change you make later in the course can be guided by them.

5 **Why nature brings peace**

We feel at peace in a forest or among greenery, and stressed in artificial places such as the car (the speaker's story of a driver who kept dangerously overtaking him, only to end up at the same traffic light ten minutes later). The reason is that nature is Allah's creation, and His attributes are reflected in it: mercy, beautiful design (a spider's web, said to be five times stronger than steel of the same thickness), and peace. Allah is As-Salam (the Source of Peace), Al-Musawwir (the Fashioner, the one who designs), Ar-Rahman (the Most Merciful), Ash-Shakur (the Most Appreciative) and Al-Wadud (the Most Loving).

6 **Build your values on the divine attributes**

If you are not clear on your values, you simply do what everyone else does, and the marketing world is happy to turn you into a consumer (Coca-Cola and Pepsi between them spend over $5 billion a year on marketing). Instead, connect your values with the divine: "I want to be more merciful because my Creator is the Most Merciful. I want to be grateful because God is the Most Appreciative. I want to be at peace because God is the Source of Peace." Loving your spouse and children is a reflection of Al-Wadud. This is the foundation the rest of the course builds on.

7 **Our purpose: khalifah and knowing Allah**

When Allah announced to the angels that He would create human beings, He called us a khalifah. Often translated "vicegerent" or "successor", in this context the speaker explains it as a representative: we are here to represent Allah, and we do that by reflecting His attributes. Allah also says He created jinn and mankind to worship Him, and Ibn Abbas explained worship here as to know Him. We do not get close to Allah by travelling in a rocket; we get close by more closely reflecting His attributes. When we feel unease without knowing why, it is often because we are not fulfilling this purpose.

8 **Start at home, and everything becomes purposeful**

We can be busy with charity and fundraising yet go home and shout at our family, because at home we are not showing mercy, love or appreciation. When did you last tell your spouse you really appreciate the food they cooked? Living by the divine attributes ends the comparison that leaves people low (the parent who could have been a chief executive, the executive who never had a family). Even the smallest act, like carrying an ant into the garden instead of killing it because you are merciful, becomes purposeful. A scholar went through all the names of Allah and showed that even names you might think you cannot reflect can be reflected in some way.

From the Qur'an, the Sunnah and the scholars

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ إِنِّى جَاعِلٌ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً ۖ قَالُوٓا۟ أَتَجْعَلُ فِيهَا مَن يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا وَيَسْفِكُ ٱلدِّمَآءَ وَنَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ وَنُقَدِّسُ لَكَ ۖ قَالَ إِنِّىٓ أَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ

And [mention, O Muḥammad], when your Lord said to the angels, "Indeed, I will make upon the earth a successive authority." They said, "Will You place upon it one who causes corruption therein and sheds blood, while we exalt You with praise and declare Your perfection?" He [Allāh] said, "Indeed, I know that which you do not know."

Surah Al-Baqarah 2:30

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ ٱلْجِنَّ وَٱلْإِنسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ

And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me.

Surah Adh-Dhariyat 51:56

> *"To worship Me" means "to know Me": the purpose of creation is to know our Creator.*
>
> **Abdullah ibn Abbas, as explained in the session**

Practical exercises

Choose your three values

1. Pause the video at the list of values and read through it slowly.
2. Write down every value that feels true to you (for example mercy, gratitude, peace, love, generosity, patience, forgiveness).
3. Narrow it down to only three that most express who you are.
4. For each one, write a sentence on why it matters to you and where it comes from.

Connect each value to a name of Allah

1. Take your three values one at a time.
2. Find the name of Allah each one reflects (for example Ar-Rahim, the All-Merciful; Ash-Shakur, the Most Appreciative; As-Salam, the Source of Peace).
3. Complete the sentence: "I want to be more ___ because Allah is ___."
4. Write one way you will live this value at home this week.

A name of Allah as the theme of the day

1. Each morning, choose one name: Ar-Rahim (the All-Merciful), Al-Karim (the Most Generous), Ash-Shakur (the Most Appreciative), As-Sabur (the Patient), Al-Ghafur (the Most Forgiving), As-Sami' (the All-Hearing) or Al-Basir (the All-Seeing).
2. Read the short poem for that name with your children, nieces, nephews or spouse.
3. During the day, look for chances to reflect it: a kind word, a gift, forgiving someone, staying calm when plans change.
4. In the evening, write down what you did and how it felt. Keep it simple and fun, even if you only manage one.

Three thank-yous tonight

1. Before the day ends, find three things to say thank you for.
2. Say at least one of them out loud to your spouse or a family member.
3. Note how they responded and how you felt.

My week of reflecting the names of Allah

Tick each day you practise.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Read the day's name with my family							
Reflected it in one action							
Said three thank-yous							

Reflection questions and answers

1. Why are you here? Which area of your life (career, family, spiritual connection, direction) do you most want to improve?

> The session lists the usual reasons people join: career problems or wanting to start their own thing, difficulties with a spouse or children, a spiritual connection that feels like something is missing, or no clear direction. Naming yours honestly means you can come out the other end with a real improvement in that area. For example: "Family. I am busy with good causes outside the home, but I am often short-tempered with my children, and I want that to change."

2. Think of a time you listened to something inspiring and nothing changed. What stopped the change from happening?

> Knowing is not enough: Shaytan has more knowledge than any of us, while the Companions changed their lives without always having much knowledge. Too much information can also leave us making no choices at all, which is why coaching offers speed and troubleshooting. For example: "I came home motivated, but I had no clear first step and nobody to check in with, so within a week I was back to my old habits."

3. Where have you felt most at peace? What attributes of Allah might you have been witnessing there?

> We feel at peace in nature because it is Allah's creation, and His attributes are reflected in it: mercy, beautiful design and peace. Names you might recognise there include As-Salam (the Source of Peace), Al-Musawwir (the Fashioner), Ar-Rahman (the Most Merciful) and Al-Wadud (the Most Loving). For example: "Walking in the woods early in the morning. I think I was witnessing As-Salam in the stillness and Al-Musawwir in the design of every leaf."

4. Which of your current choices are driven by what everyone else does, or by marketing, rather than by your own values?

> If you are not clear on your values, you simply do what everyone else does, and the marketing world is happy to turn you into a consumer (Coca-Cola and Pepsi between them spend over $5 billion a year on marketing). A good answer spots specific choices and asks which value should guide them instead. For example: "Upgrading my phone every year. It is not something I value; I do it because everyone around me does."

5. What does being a khalifah, a representative of Allah, mean for how you behave at home?

> The session explains khalifah as a representative: we are here to represent Allah by reflecting His attributes, and we get close to Him by reflecting them more closely. It also warns that we can be busy with charity and fundraising, then go home and show no mercy, love or appreciation. For example: "My family should see mercy and appreciation from me first. I will properly thank my spouse for the food they cook, not only be kind to strangers."

6. Which divine attribute do you reflect least towards your spouse or children, and what would one small step look like?

> Think about the names highlighted in the session: Ar-Rahman (the Most Merciful), Ash-Shakur (the Most Appreciative), Al-Wadud (the Most Loving) and As-Salam (the Source of Peace). Loving your spouse and children is itself a reflection of Al-Wadud, and appreciation at home is often what is missing. For example: "Ash-Shakur. I rarely thank my children. My small step is three thank-yous each evening, with at least one said out loud to them."

7. Which ordinary task in your day could become purposeful if you did it to reflect a name of Allah?

> Living by the divine attributes makes even the smallest act purposeful, like carrying an ant into the garden instead of killing it because you want to be merciful. Any routine task can be done with a name of Allah in mind. For example: "Cooking dinner. If I do it to reflect Al-Wadud, out of love for my family, rather than as a chore, it becomes an act that brings me closer to Allah."

My action plan

- [ ] I will choose my three values and bring them to the next session.
- [ ] I will link each of my values to a name of Allah.
- [ ] I will make one name of Allah the theme of each day this week with my family.
- [ ] I will find three things to say thank you for each day.
- [ ] I will be ready to share how the week went in the next session.